P-S-617D
July 15, 1974
SUPERSEDING
P-S-617C
April 23, 1969

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SOAP, TOILET (FOR SOFT AND HARD WATER USE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of toilet bar soap (detergent bar) for use in soft and hard water (see 6.1 and 6.4).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
FED-STD-536 - Soap and Soap-Products (Including Synthetic Detergents): Sampling and Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof of Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads For 40" x 48" Pallets.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

E 70 - Method of Test of pH of Aqueous Solutions with the Glass Electrode

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Soap and Detergent Association Standards

Test Procedure and Standards - ABS and LAS Biodegradability; Scientific and Technical Report No. 3.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Soap and Detergent Association, 475 Park Avenue South at 32nd Street, New York, NY 10016.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The finished detergent bar shall be composed of a compatible mixture of synthetic organic detergents, foaming agents, and mild perfume, with or without sodium or potassium soap. It also may contain fatty acids, coconut oil, and fatty free alcohol.

3.2 Bar weight and size. The detergent bar shall have an average weight of not less than 3-3/4 ounces per bar. The bar dimensions shall be as follows:

TABLE I. Dimensions

Length	3-1/2 ± 1/4 inches
Width	2-1/4 ± 1/4 inches
Thickness	3/4 ± 1/4 inch

3.3 Composition. The composition of the detergent bar shall conform to the requirements specified in table II, when tested as specified in 4.2.3 and expressed as indicated in 3.3.1.

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TABLE II. Composition

Ingredients	Percent by weight Minimum	Maximum
Moisture and volatile matter		13.0
Anhydrous, salt-free, synthetic organic detergent	25.0	
Sum of synthetic organic detergent and anhydrous sodium or potassium soap (as applicable see 3.1)	60.0	
Free alkali, calculated as sodium hydroxide		0.10
Free fatty acid, calculated as oleic acid		30.0
Ash insoluble in water		2.0
Starch		00
Biodegradability	90.0	

3.3.1 Computation. To determine compliance with the composition requirements of table II, the moisture and volatile matter content shall be expressed as determined on the detergent bar and the test results of all other ingredients shall be expressed on the basis of a soap containing 12 percent moisture and volatile matter. To express these results on a 12 percent moisture and volatile matter basis, the analytical test results are multiplied by a factor (F) derived as follows:

$$F = \frac{100 - 12}{100 - M}$$

M = Average percent moisture and volatile matter of the sample units tested.

3.4 Stability. The detergent bar shall be firm, smooth, nonabrasive, and shall not crumble or develop cracks when tested as specified in 4.2.3.

3.5 Acidity (pH). The pH of the detergent bar in distilled water shall be 6.8 to 10.3 when tested as specified in 4.2.3.

3.6 Odor. The detergent bar shall be mildly perfumed. After washing with the detergent bar and rinsing with hot water, there shall be no objectionable residual odors on the skin.

3.7 Color. The detergent bar shall be the color normally furnished by the supplier in his commercial practice.

3.8 Labeling. When specified (see 5.4.1 and 5.4.2), each packaged bar shall be marked with the nomenclature, Federal Stock Number, Specification, name and address of manufacturer, contract number and the following statement:

Can be Used for Bathing and Shaving in Soft or Hard Water.

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3.9 Workmanship. The finished detergent bar shall be firm, homogeneous in appearance and texture, not crumbly, and shall be free from objectionable odor, gouges, holes, breaks, cracks, crushed surfaces, crushed edges, or corners. The detergent bar shall compare favorably for firmness, uniformity in texture, and surface smoothness with commercial soap bars (see 6.5).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificate of compliance is submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for examinations and tests shall consist of all the end items prepared in a single batch and submitted for inspection at one time.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.2.2.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in the applicable subparagraphs below at the inspection levels (AQL's) set forth in 4.2.2.3. The lot size, for purposes of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105 shall be expressed in units of bars of detergent for the examinations in 4.2.2.1.1, 4.2.2.1.2, and 4.2.2.1.3, in units of shipping containers for the examination in 4.2.2.2.1, and in units of pallets for the examination in 4.2.2.2.2.

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4.2.2.1.1 Examination for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bar of detergent.

Examine	Defects
Color	Color not uniform.
Odor	Objectionable odor: rancid, fishy, or horsey. Not mildly perfumed. Residual odor on skin after washing and rinsing with hot water.
Workmanship	Not homogeneous in appearance and texture. Not firm (crumbly). Any gouge, hole, break, crack, crushed surface, edge or corner. Does not conform favorably with comparison sample.

4.2.2.1.2 Examination of the detergent bar for defects in dimensions. Sample bars shall be measured for compliance with dimensions specified. Any dimension not within specified tolerance shall be classified a defect.

4.2.2.1.3 Examination of detergent bar for average weight. The average bar weight shall be determined by averaging the weight of all the sample units selected for the examination in 4.2.2.1.1. Average weight less than specified in 3.2 shall be cause to reject the lot.

4.2.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery.

4.2.2.2.1 Examination for packaging, packing and marking. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking complies with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery except that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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Examine	Defects
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping or, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Contents	Number of bars of detergent per shipping container is less than specified.

4.2.2.2.2 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine whether the palletization complies with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot.

Examine	Defects
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Not as specified. Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; incomplete; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.

4.2.2.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examinations. The inspection levels, for determining the sample size and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's), expressed in defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection levels	AQL's
4.2.2.1.1	I	2.5
4.2.2.1.2	S-2	10.0
4.2.2.1.3	I	N/A
4.2.2.2.1	S-2	2.5
4.2.2.2.2	S-1	6.5

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4.2.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested for the characteristics specified in table II. The methods of the testing specified in FED-STD-536, wherever applicable and as specified in table IV, shall be followed for each inspection lot. The lot size shall be expressed in bars of detergent. The sample unit shall be composed of six randomly selected bars of detergent. The sample size shall be as specified below. As specified in table IV, tests shall be performed on composite sample or on sample unit basis. Three bars of detergent from each sample unit shall be ground and thoroughly mixed to obtain the composite. Each sample unit and the composite shall be placed in separate sealed airtight and watertight metal or glass containers. Two specimens from each sample unit, for moisture and volatile matter determination, shall be weighed immediately upon opening the sealed sample unit containers. Care shall be exercised to prevent the loss or absorption of moisture or loss of volatile matter during the sampling, weighing, and storage of the specimens and samples. The lot shall be unacceptable if one sample unit or the composite sample fails to meet any test requirement specified.

TABLE III. Sampling for end item testing

Lot size (bars)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 or more	5

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TABLE IV. Instructions for testing of the end item

Characteristic	Specification reference		Requirements applicable to		Number determinations per unit	Results reported as	
	Requirements	Test method	Comp samp	Samp units		Pass or fail	Numerically to nearest
Moisture and volatile matter	Table II	5201 1/		X	2		Average of 2 determinations to nearest 0.1 percent
Andhydrous, salt-free, synthetic organic detergent	Table II	6501 1/	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.1 percent
Anhydrous, salt-free, sodium or potassium soap	Table II	5601 1/	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.1 percent
Free alkali	Table II	5301 1/	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.01 percent
Free fatty acid	Table II	5301 1/	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.01 percent
Ash insoluble in water	Table II	4.3.1	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.01 percent.
Starch	Table II	4.3.2	X		1	X	
Stability	3.4	4.3.3		X	1	X	
Acidity (pH)	3.5	4.3.4	X		2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 0.1 pH unit.

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TABLE IV. Instructions for testing of the end item (cont'd)

Characteristic	Specification reference		Requirements applicable to		Number determinations per units	Results reported as	
	Requirements	Test method	Comp samp	Samp units		Pass or fail	Numerically to nearest
Biodegradability, percent	Table II	4.3.5		X	2		Average of 2 determinations, to nearest 1.0 percent.

1/ Indicates FED-STD-536.

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4.3 Test methods.

4.3.1 Ash insoluble in water. Weigh, in duplicate, into porcelain crucibles, 10.00 gram samples sliced into thin shavings. Heat the ash sample thoroughly over a high temperature burner. When ashed thoroughly (three hours), cool and dissolve each specimen in 100 mls of hot, distilled water. Again cool, filter using a tared Gooch crucible, plus filter paper disk. Dry crucible, paper disk, and residue to a constant weight in an oven at 105°C.

Calculate the ash insoluble in water as follows:

$$\% \text{ ash insoluble in water} = \frac{B}{A} \times 100$$

Where A = weight of original sample.
B = weight of dried residue.

4.3.2 Starch. Place a few drops of a solution, made up by dissolving 6 grams of potassium iodide and 2 grams of iodine in 100 mls. of distilled water, directly on a 15 gram portion of the sample and acidify with several drops of dilute sulfuric acid (1 volume of acid to 1 volume of distilled water). The formation of a blue color indicates the presence of starch.

4.3.3 Stability. A sample bar of toilet soap shall be immersed undisturbed in 1-liter of distilled water at 25° to 30°C. for 1 hour. The bar shall be removed from the water and allowed to drain and dry at room temperature for 24 hours. The dry bar shall be examined for firmness, smoothness, and abrasiveness of surface, formation of cracks and for crumbliness.

4.3.4 Determination of pH. Determine the pH of a 0.5 percent solution of the soap in distilled water at 25° ± 1°C. using a pH meter with an alkali-resistant glass electrode in accordance with ASTM E 70.

4.3.5 Biodegradability. The supplier shall certify by a certificate of compliance that the biodegradability meets the minimum requirement of 90 percent. The certificate shall be accompanied by actual test data (Field or laboratory) including the detail test procedure utilized in making the biodegradability determination. When the detergent is an alkyl benzene sulfonate or a linear alkylate sulfonate, the biodegradability shall be determined in accordance with the Test Procedure and Standards - ABS and LAS Biodegradability, Scientific and Technical Report No. 3 of the Soap and Detergent Association.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each bar of detergent shall be provided with an individual paper wrapper or foil. The wrapper or foil shall be secured and sealed. An inner paper sleeve may be used around the bars of detergent prior to packaging. The materials used for the sleeve and packaging shall neither affect nor be affected by the product being packaged.

5.1.2 Level C (commercial packaging). Each bar of detergent shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage or deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred and forty-four bars of detergent packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be provided with a case liner constructed in accordance with MIL-L-10547, type I, except that the case liner shall be fabricated from material consisting of a lamination of 30-pound basis weight (24 by 36 - 500) kraft paper and 0.001-inch minimum thickness polyethylene film. The bottom and side seams shall be heat sealed with seams not less than 3/8-inch in width. Closure of the case liner shall be accomplished by heat sealing or by a lockseam folded flat against the contents. Excess air shall be expelled prior to heat sealing the closure. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred and forty-four bars of detergent, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. When unwrapped bars of detergent are specified, each shipping container shall be provided with a case liner constructed as specified in 5.2.1.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

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5.2.2.2 Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), for Civil Agencies, the quantity of soap and the shipping container shall be as specified in 5.2.2, except that the grade of fiberboard shall not be stated.

5.2.3 Level C. Bars of detergent, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), bars of detergent packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123. Each wrapped bar of detergent shall be marked with the manufacturer's normal commercial markings, or as specified in 3.8.

5.4.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Each wrapped bar of detergent shall be marked with the information specified in 3.8.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The detergent bar covered by this specification is intended for bathing or shaving using either soft or hard water.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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c. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
d. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Basis of purchase. The detergent bar should be purchased by net weight provided the moisture and volatile matter content is neither above nor below 10 percent.

6.3.1 Unless otherwise specified, on deliveries containing 7 to 12 percent moisture and volatile, matter, settlement should be made on the basis of a product containing 10 percent moisture and volatile matter, that is, 0.90 pound nonvolatile matter should be considered 1 pound of detergent bar. On deliveries of detergent bars containing less than 7 percent moisture and volatile matter, settlement should be made as though the detergent bar contained 7 percent moisture and volatile matter. The net weight of the material to be paid for on a 10 percent moisture and volatile matter basis, is calculated as follows:

$$W = R \times \frac{(100 - L)}{90}$$

Where: W = net weight of material to be paid for on a 10 percent moisture and volatile matter basis.
R = net weight of material as received.
L = actual percent moisture and volatile matter.
90 = percent nonvolatile matter.

Examples:

I. When detergent bar contains 11 percent moisture and volatile matter.

Where: R = 1 pound

$$W = 1 \times \frac{(100 - 11)}{90} = 0.989 \text{ pound}$$

Cost of detergent bar = number of pounds of detergent bars as received x 0.989 x price per pound.

II. When detergent bar contains 8 percent moisture and volatile matter.

Where: R = 1 pound

$$W = \frac{1 \times (100 - 8)}{90} = 1.022 \text{ pound}$$

Cost of detergent bar = number of pounds of detergent bars as received x 1.022 x price per pound

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III. When detergent bar contains 7 percent moisture and volatile matter.

Where: $R = 1$ pound

$$W = \frac{1 \times (100 - 7)}{90} = 1.033 \text{ pound}$$

Cost of detergent bar = number of pounds of detergent bars as received x 1.033 x price per pound.

6.4 Classification comparison. Sizes 1 and 2 in P-S-617C, have been deleted in this revision since only one size is now covered.

6.5 Acceptable quality. The following commercial toilet soap bars are acceptable for firmness, uniformity of texture, and surface smoothness (see 3.9).

Vel Beauty Bar	Colgate Palmolive Co.
Dove Beauty Bar	Lever Bros. Co.
Zest Deodorant Beauty Bar	Protector and Gamble Co.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - MD

User activities:

Navy - SA, MC, MS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
HEW-FDA
VA-DMS
NASA-LRC

Project No. 8520-0046

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

P-S-617D Soap, Toilet (For Soft And Hard Water Use)

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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